

executed, but there are others where timing matters.

The action as Batman is a lot like the quick-time events from God of War and that isn't always bad. There are times when you have to help Batman plan his moves and sit back and watch him execute them. When you don the role of the world's greatest detective, you also have to solve crimes. This is done with Telltale's own take on 'detective mode' (the one we have seen in Arkham Knight). You recreate the events of a crime scene to understand what really happened and this is an interesting puzzle to solve.

The gameplay as Bruce Wayne is much simpler. All you need to do is choose the corresponding dialogue from the screen and watch the story unfold.

I must admit, I am one who enjoys action adventure games the most and it's a good thing the first episode of the Telltale Batman game was about 2.5 hours long. The story is intriguing enough to leave you wanting more and the gameplay is fresh for what it offers. However, if you are one that doesn't enjoy story driven games, then the gameplay will not appeal to you.

GRAPHICS

If there is one place where the game suffers it is with the graphics. We tested the Xbox One version of the game and the resolution is less than 720p. The experience of the game is smooth overall but there are times when the frame rate really dropped hampering the overall experience.

PROs

- Immersive story
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- Fun gameplay

CONs

- Won't appeal to everyone
- Resolution and frame rate could have been better
- Some quick-time sequences are gimmicky

There is also something unnatural about the way Bruce Wayne walks and some of Batman's antics look unnatural and distracting.

On a positive note, Telltale has always chosen cell shaded comic book style graphics for its games and for the most part, it works. The design and animation of Batman's suite pays homage to Frank Miller Dark Knight in quite a few ways and we like it.

There are times when the cell shaded comic book style graphics look weak and facial animations seem unnatural. For some, they may be distracting and take away from the overall experience.

SOUND

The background score of the game is good varying between absolute silence and high tempo when required. A special mention goes out to Troy Baker who has voiced the caped crusader. For those unaware, he had taken up the role of the Joker in Batman: Arkham Origins so it's nice to see him on this side of the fence for a change. Another voice actor to look out for is Travis Willingham who plays Harvey Dent. So far



he has done a good job but I'm looking forward to his version of Two-Face. Overall, the sound design of the game is good.

TO BUY OR NOT TO BUY

The downside is that the experience ends in about 2-3 hours and the inconsistent frame rate coupled with the low resolution is jarring if you know where to look. The upside is that for its duration, the experience (mostly the story) will keep you wanting more. There are twists and turns in the plot that will make you question your decision at every turn. The downside is that the impact of some of these decisions isn't as grave as it should be. The game is ideal for Telltale fans and people that enjoy a good story. If you however are an action adventure junkie, then this may not appeal to you. *

MOAR

- **PLATFORMS:** PlayStation 4, Xbox One, Android, iOS, Microsoft Windows, PlayStation 3, Xbox 360, Mac OS
- **PRICE:** ₹380 (for Episode 1 on Xbox One)
- **PUBLISHER:** Telltale Games
- **DEVELOPER:** Telltale Games